



History of HTTP

HTTP was invented by Tim Berners-Lee and his team at CERN. They also invented HTML, and the concepts and technologies of Web Server and Web Browser.

Development of HTTP was initiated in 1989 and summarized in a simple document.

Development of early HTTP RFC documents started a few years later in a coordinated effort by the IETF and the W3C.

The first web server went live in 1990.



CERN httpd (AKA W3C httpd) was the first web server software. It was implemented in C.

It was developed at CERN from 1990 onwards by Tim Berners-Lee, Ari Luotonen, and Henrik Frystyk Nielsen.

- HTTP/0.9 (1991)
 - The first documented official version of HTTP
 - Less than 700 words long
 - Supported only GET method, allowing clients to only retrieve HTML documents from the server, but not supporting any other file format
- HTTP/1.0-draft

- Since 1992, a new document was written to specify the evolution of the basic protocol towards its next full version
- HTTP/1.0 (1996)
 - RFC 1945 published as a final revision what had been used in previous 4 years as a pre-standard HTTP/1.0-draft (which was already used by many web browsers and web servers)
- HTTP/1.1 (1997)
 - RFC 2068
 - Later in 1999, RFC 2616 was released to include all improvements and updates based on previous HTTP/1.1 specifications
 - In June 2014, the HTTP WG released an updated six-part HTTP/1.1 specification obsoleting RFC 2616
 - [RFC 7230](#)
 - [RFC 7231](#)
 - [RFC 7232](#)
 - [RFC 7233](#)
 - [RFC 7234](#)
 - [RFC 7235](#)
- HTTP/2 (2015)
 - Published as RFC 7540
- HTTP/3 (2022)
 - IETF standardized HTTP/3 as RFC 9114